Hijacking the Grid

Student sheet · Terminale : tronc commun B2 · spécialité LLCER: towards C1 · The New York City Marathon as an urban and social disruptor.

Use this sheet in class or at home. The full documents, the video and the answer keys are on the sequence page.

Guiding question

How does the New York City Marathon temporarily hijack the city's inequalities and turn its streets into a theater of psychological resilience?

Lesson 1. History and figures

Write three short facts you want to remember (year + what changed).

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One sentence about the painting by Childe Hassam, and one sentence about a street during the marathon today:

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Lesson 2. Emphatic inversion

Complete with inversion. Keep the meaning.

1. The city has never closed so many streets for a race. → Never .....
2. The race left the park, and it crossed all five boroughs. → Not only .....
3. The runners had reached the bridge when the wall of sound began. → Hardly .....

Write one sentence of your own with *No sooner … than*:

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Lesson 3. The mayor at the water station

After the video: what does the mayor do, and what does this gesture say about public space?

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Lesson 4. Words for the course

Choose eight words or phrases and write a short meaning or an example (you can copy them later onto flashcards):

Word or phrase	Meaning or example

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Lesson 5. Plan your article

Title idea: .....

My position (genuine unity, a 24-hour illusion, or a more nuanced view):

Two arguments, with one fact or example for each:

One concession, then my conclusion:

Flashcards

Make your own bristol cards. One item per card. Front: the English word or structure, in colour. Back: the French and one short example. Sort them into two piles (I know this / I do not know this yet), then use three boxes: a successful card moves forward; a failed card goes back to box 1.

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